Client Finder Agent STARTER & PRO

SETUP GUIDE

Setup guide

Connect Google, Claude, your sheet and Gmail, then run your first search with the Client Finder workflow.

Version 1.0.0 · Tested on n8n 1.123.83 and 2.42.3

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Before you read

This guide sets up the paid Client Finder workflow, `client-finder-web-design.json`. The first setup takes about 30-45 minutes.

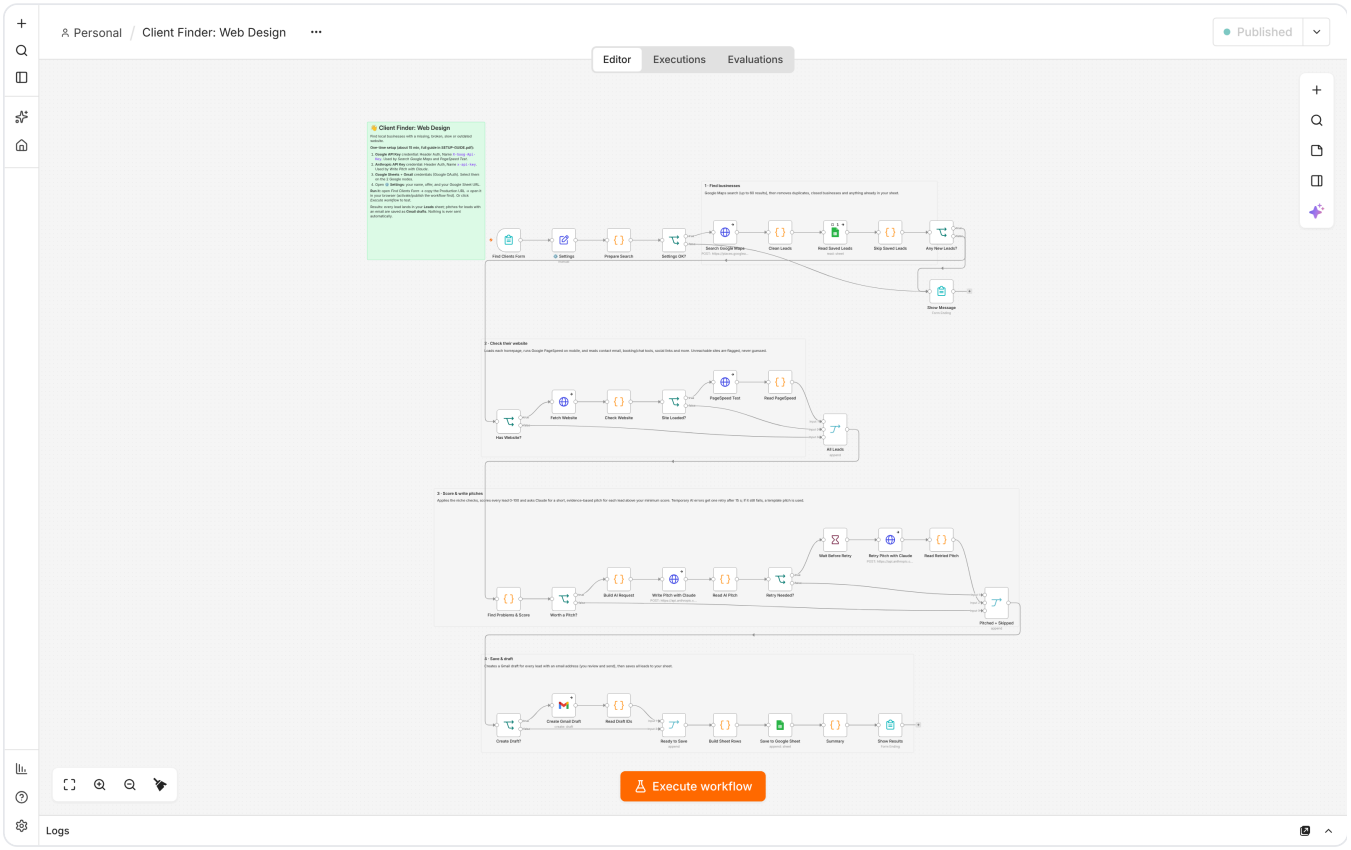
Pro buyers: the steps are the same for all five niche workflows. Only the checks and the default service and offer change. Set up one workflow with this guide, then use PRO-GUIDE.pdf for the other niches and the Follow-up Autopilot.

Four words you will see often:

- **n8n** is the automation tool that runs the workflow.
- A **workflow** is a chain of small steps called **nodes**. Each node does one job.
- An **API key** is a password that lets n8n use a service, such as Google Maps, for you.
- A **credential** is a key or login that n8n stores safely and reuses.

How it works

You type a business type and a city into a form, for example `dentists` and `Austin, TX`. The workflow does the rest. Node names are in *italics*.



The web-design workflow after import. The coloured notes explain each stage.

1. Read the form and your settings

Find Clients Form receives your search. ⚙️ *Settings* adds your name, offer and sheet address. *Prepare Search* checks them. If something is missing, *Settings OK?* shows a message that says what to fix.

2. Find businesses on Google Maps

Search Google Maps asks Google's official Places API for matching businesses (no scraping). Google returns up to 20 per request and at most 60 per search. *Clean Leads* removes duplicates and closed businesses.

3. Skip businesses you already have

Read Saved Leads reads your Google Sheet. *Skip Saved Leads* removes every business already there, using Google's unique **Place ID**. Nobody is pitched twice.

4. Check each website

Has Website? separates businesses with and without a website. *Fetch Website* opens each homepage like a browser (20-second limit, up to 5 redirects). *Check Website* reads it: did it load, does it fit phones, what year is in the footer, is there a public email? For sites that loaded, *PageSpeed Test* runs Google's mobile speed test and *Read PageSpeed* reads the scores. *All Leads* joins everything together.

5. Find problems and score each lead

Find Problems & Score runs the checks below. Each proven problem adds points. *Worth a Pitch?* decides which leads get a pitch.

6. Write a pitch with Claude

Build AI Request sends Claude (Anthropic's AI model) only verified facts: name, category, address, rating, reviews, website and the problems with their evidence, plus your name, business, service and offer. *Write Pitch with Claude* returns an email subject and body, a short DM (direct message) and a call opener. If Claude is busy, *Wait Before Retry* waits 15 seconds and *Retry Pitch with Claude* tries once more. If that fails, a ready-made template pitch is used.

7. Create Gmail drafts

Create Draft? checks that there is a public email, a pitch, and drafts are turned on. *Create Gmail Draft* saves the email in Gmail **Drafts**. **Nothing is ever sent.** You review and send every email yourself.

8. Save and report

Build Sheet Rows puts the best leads first, *Save to Google Sheet* adds them to the **Leads** tab, and *Show Results* shows a summary in your browser.

The web-design checks

Check	Points	When it counts	Example evidence
No website	45	Google Maps lists no website	"No website is listed on their Google Business Profile..."

Check	Points	When it counts	Example evidence
Website down	45	The site does not load: expired domain, server error, "not found" (404), or no answer in 20 seconds	"...didn't load when checked: the homepage returns "page not found" (404)."
Security certificate error	40	The security certificate is broken or expired	"...browsers show visitors a "your connection is not private" warning."
Placeholder website	40	Only a "coming soon", parked or default page	"...is only a placeholder page..., not a real website."
Slow on mobile	30	Google PageSpeed scores the mobile site below 50/100	"Google PageSpeed scores the mobile site 23/100; the main content takes 9.8 s to appear on a phone."
Not mobile-friendly	30	No mobile **viewport** (the code that fits a page to a phone screen)	"...shows as a shrunken desktop page on mobile."
Not secure (no HTTPS)	25	The site does not use **HTTPS** (the secure, padlock address)	"...Chrome marks it "Not secure" next to the address."
Outdated website	20	The footer year is 3 or more years old	"The website footer still says © 2019..."
Weak SEO basics	10	Google's Lighthouse SEO test (basic search-friendliness) scores below 80, or no page title, meta description (the summary Google shows in results) or main heading	"Google's Lighthouse SEO check scores the homepage 72/100..."

> **Example:** The evidence above is example data from our made-up test businesses.

Scores and priorities

The score is the sum of the points, up to 100. Each lead then gets a priority:

Priority	Score	What it usually means
Hot	60-100	Several clear problems. Contact first.
Warm	30-59	One serious problem or a few smaller ones
Low	1-29	Small problems; no pitch by default
None	0	No problem found

> **Example:** In our test data, Bright Smile Studio is not mobile-friendly (30), not secure (25), outdated (20) and has weak SEO basics (10): 85 points, **Hot**. Sunrise Family Dental in Austin, TX is slow on mobile (30) and outdated (20): 50 points, **Warm**.

Only verified evidence counts. If a website blocks automated visits, its checks are skipped instead of guessed, so it may score 0.

> **Important:** Emails come only from what a business publishes on its homepage, and many publish none. Those leads still get a DM message and a call opener.

Before you start

Accounts you need

You need	Why	Notes
n8n (Cloud or self-hosted, version 1.123 or newer)	Runs the workflow	Works on n8n 1.x and 2.x.
A **Google account**	Google Cloud project, API key, Google Sheets	Any Gmail or Google Workspace account.
An **Anthropic account**	Claude writes the pitches	A Claude.ai chat plan does not include API credits.
A **Gmail or Google Workspace inbox**	Drafts are saved here; you send from here	Use the inbox you want replies in.
A payment card	Google Cloud billing and Anthropic credits	See the costs below.

Running costs

You pay each service directly for what you use.

Service	What it costs	Notes
Google Places API (New)	Free monthly usage, then pay as you go	One request returns up to 20 businesses, so a 60-business search is 3 requests. Prices change: check https://mapsplatform.google.com/pricing/
PageSpeed Insights API	Free	The default limit is 25,000 tests per day.
Claude (Anthropic)	Roughly 1-2 US cents per pitch with the default model	Only leads at or above **minScoreToPitch** go to Claude. Cheaper models cost less.
n8n	Your n8n plan	Each search is one workflow run (an *execution*), including test runs. Self-hosted n8n is free software; you pay for the server.
Google Sheets and Gmail	Free	Included with your Google account.

> **Cost:** For example, if 10 leads get a pitch, Claude costs roughly 10-20 US cents, plus up to 3 Places requests.

Step 1: Set up Google Cloud

1.1 Create a project

1. Go to `console.cloud.google.com` and sign in.
2. Click the project picker at the top, then **New Project**.
3. Name it `Client Finder`, click **Create**, and check it is selected at the top.

1.2 Turn on billing and set a budget alert

Google requires billing for Maps services, even inside the free monthly usage.

1. Open the menu (three lines, top left) and click **Billing**.
2. Click **Link a billing account** (or **Create billing account**) and add your card.
3. Open **Budgets & alerts** and click **Create budget**.
4. Choose a small amount, for example 10 in your currency, and click **Finish**.

> **Warning:** A budget alert only emails you; it does not stop spending. For a hard limit, lower the daily quota of Places API (New) in **APIs & Services**.

1.3 Enable the two APIs

1. Open the menu and go to **APIs & Services** > **Library**.
2. Search for `Places API (New)`, open it and click **Enable**.
3. Do the same for `PageSpeed Insights API`.

> **Warning:** Google also lists an older "Places API" without "(New)". You need **Places API (New)**.

1.4 Create and restrict the API key

1. Go to **APIs & Services** > **Credentials**.
2. Click **Create credentials** > **API key**. Copy the key for Step 5.
3. Click the key's name to open its settings.
4. Under **Application restrictions**, choose **None**. n8n runs on a server, so website or app restrictions would block it.
5. Under **API restrictions**, choose **Restrict key**. Tick **Places API (New)** and **PageSpeed Insights API**, then click **OK**.
6. Click **Save**. Changes can take a few minutes to work.

> **Warning:** Treat the key like a password. If it leaks, delete it on the **Credentials** page and create a new one.

Step 2: Get your Anthropic API key

1. Go to `console.anthropic.com` and create an account or sign in. The page may move you to a newer Anthropic address; that is fine.
2. Open **API keys** and click **Create key**.
3. Name it `Client Finder` and click **Create**.
4. Copy the key now. It starts with `sk-ant-`. Anthropic shows it only once.
5. Open **Billing** and buy prepaid credits. A small amount, for example 5-10 US dollars, is enough to start.

> **Tip:** New Anthropic accounts start with lower usage limits. Anthropic raises them over time as you buy more credits.

Step 3: Create your CRM sheet

A **CRM** is a list of contacts and where each one stands. `Client-Finder-CRM.xlsx` is your template, with three tabs: **Leads**, **Pipeline** (live counts) and **How to use**.

Option A: Upload to Google Drive

1. Go to `drive.google.com` with the Google account you will connect to n8n.
2. Click **New** > **File upload** and choose `Client-Finder-CRM.xlsx`.
3. Double-click the file to open it.
4. Click **File** > **Save as Google Sheets**. A new tab opens with a real Google Sheet.

Option B: Import into a new sheet

1. Go to `sheets.google.com` and open a blank spreadsheet.
2. Click **File** > **Import** > **Upload** and choose `Client-Finder-CRM.xlsx`.
3. Choose **Replace spreadsheet** and click **Import data**.

After either option

Check that the first tab is called **Leads**. Copy the full address from your browser's address bar (it starts with `https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/`) for Step 6.

> **Important:** Keep the tab name **Leads** and the header row exactly as they are. You may add your own columns to the right of **Notes**.

> **Warning:** In Option A, use the new Google Sheet, not the uploaded .xlsx file. If the title shows an **XLSX** label, you are still in the Excel file.

Step 4: Import the workflow

1. In n8n, go to your **Workflows** list.
2. Click **Create Workflow** (in some versions **Create** > **Workflow**, or **+**). An empty canvas opens.
3. Click the **...** menu at the top right and choose **Import from File...**.
4. Select `client-finder-web-design.json`. Pro buyers find it in the `workflows` folder.
5. Click **Save**.

> **Important:** Import each file only once: two copies share one form address. Upgrading from Starter to Pro? Keep your Starter workflow and skip the Pro copy of `client-finder-web-design.json`.

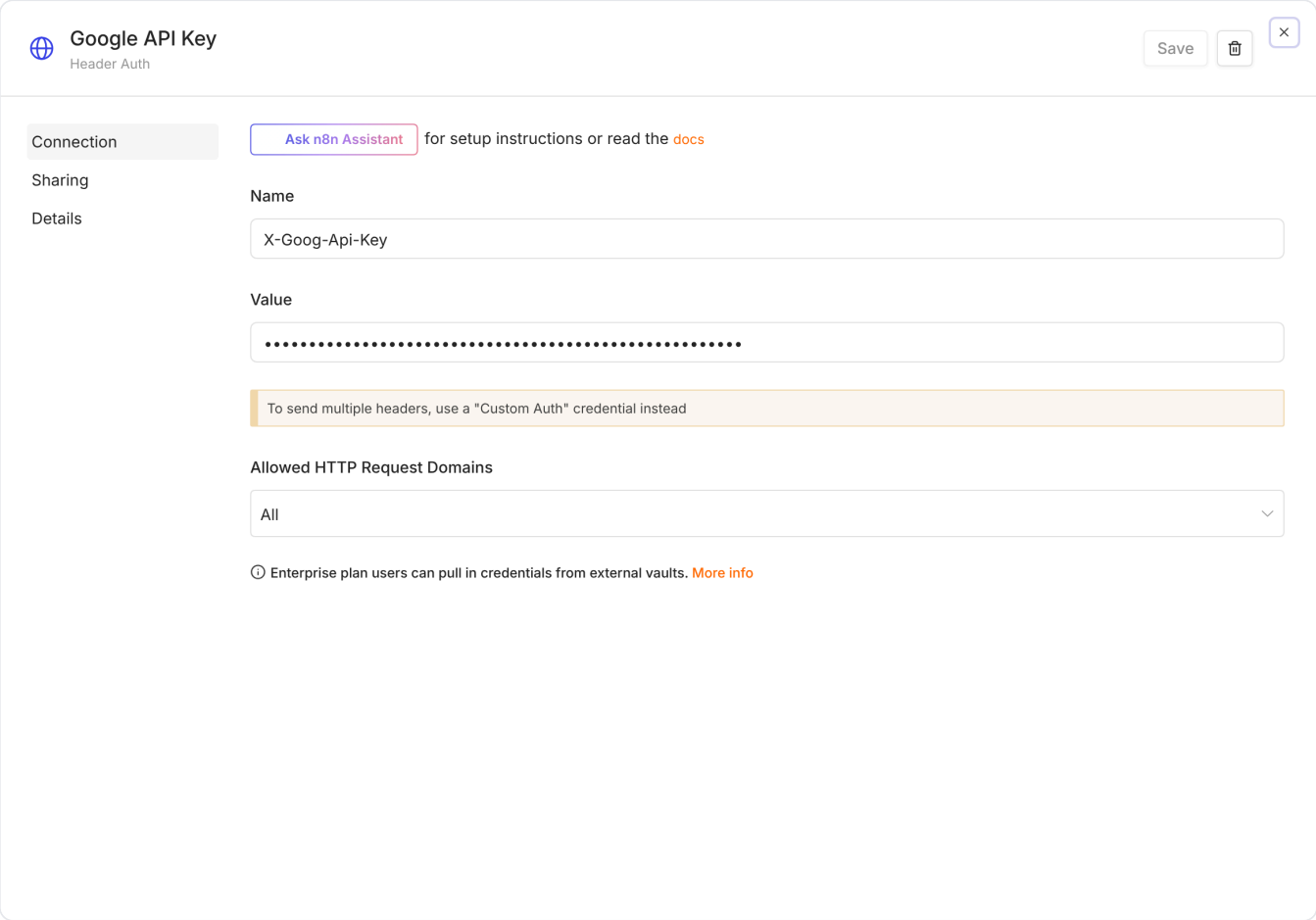
Step 5: Add the four credentials

Credential (name it)	n8n type	Exact settings	Nodes that use it
Google API Key	**Header Auth**	**Name**: `X-Goog-Api-Key`. **Value**: your Google key.	*Search Google Maps*, *PageSpeed Test*
Anthropic API Key	**Header Auth**	**Name**: `x-api-key`. **Value**: your key (starts with `sk-ant-`).	*Write Pitch with Claude*, *Retry Pitch with Claude*
Google Sheets account	**Google Sheets OAuth2 API**	**Sign in with Google** (Cloud), or your own Client ID and Secret (self-hosted, 5.4)	*Read Saved Leads*, *Save to Google Sheet*
Gmail account	**Gmail OAuth2 API**	Same as Google Sheets	*Create Gmail Draft*

A **header** is a hidden label sent with each request; Google and Anthropic look for your key under these names.

5.1 Google API Key

1. Double-click *Search Google Maps*.
2. Leave **Authentication** (**Generic Credential Type**) and **Generic Auth Type** (**Header Auth**) as they are.
3. Open **Credential for Header Auth** and choose **Create new credential**.
4. In **Name**, type `X-Goog-Api-Key`. In **Value**, paste your Google key with no spaces.
5. Click the dialog title, rename it `Google API Key`, and click **Save**.
6. Open *PageSpeed Test* and choose **Google API Key** there too.



A Header Auth credential: Name is the header name, Value is your key.

5.2 Anthropic API Key

1. Double-click *Write Pitch with Claude*. In **Credential for Header Auth**, choose **Create new credential**.
2. In **Name**, type `x-api-key` (lower case). In **Value**, paste your `sk-ant-` key.
3. Rename it `Anthropic API Key` and click **Save**.
4. Open *Retry Pitch with Claude* and choose **Anthropic API Key** there too.

> **Warning:** Both keys use the same credential type. Do not mix them up: Claude nodes need **Anthropic API Key**, Google nodes need **Google API Key**.

5.3 Google Sheets and Gmail on n8n Cloud

1. Double-click *Read Saved Leads*. In **Credential to connect with**, choose **Create new credential**.
2. Click **Sign in with Google**, choose the account that owns your sheet and allow access. Click **Save**.
3. Choose the same credential on *Save to Google Sheet*.
4. On *Create Gmail Draft*, create a credential the same way with the inbox you send from.

> **Tip:** Leave the document and sheet fields in the Google Sheets nodes alone. They read your sheet address from ⚙️ *Settings*.

5.4 Google Sheets and Gmail on self-hosted n8n

Self-hosted n8n needs your own Google login app, called an **OAuth client**. Both credentials can share it.

A. Enable two more APIs. In Google Cloud, go to **APIs & Services** > **Library**. Enable **Google Sheets API** and **Gmail API** in your Client Finder project.

B. Set up the consent screen (the page Google shows when you sign in).

1. Go to **APIs & Services** > **OAuth consent screen** (Google may call it **Google Auth Platform**). Click **Get started** if you see it.
2. Enter an app name, such as `Client Finder`, and your email.
3. For **Audience** (or **User type**), choose **External**.
4. Finish the remaining screens and click **Create**.
5. Under **Audience** > **Test users**, click **Add users**, enter your own Gmail address and save.

C. Create the OAuth client.

1. In n8n, create a new credential on *Read Saved Leads* and copy the **OAuth Redirect URL** it shows (like `https://your-n8n-address/rest/oauth2-credential/callback`).
2. In Google Cloud, go to **Clients** (or **Credentials** > **Create credentials** > **OAuth client ID**).
3. For **Application type**, choose **Web application**.
4. Under **Authorized redirect URIs**, click **Add URI** and paste the n8n address exactly.
5. Click **Create**. Copy the **Client ID** and **Client secret**. Google may show the secret only once.

D. Publish the app. Under **Audience**, click **Publish app** and confirm. The status changes to **In production**.

> **Important:** While the consent screen is in **Testing**, Google ends your login after 7 days, and the workflow loses Sheets and Gmail. Publish the app before you connect n8n. If you connected during Testing, sign in again in both credentials after publishing.

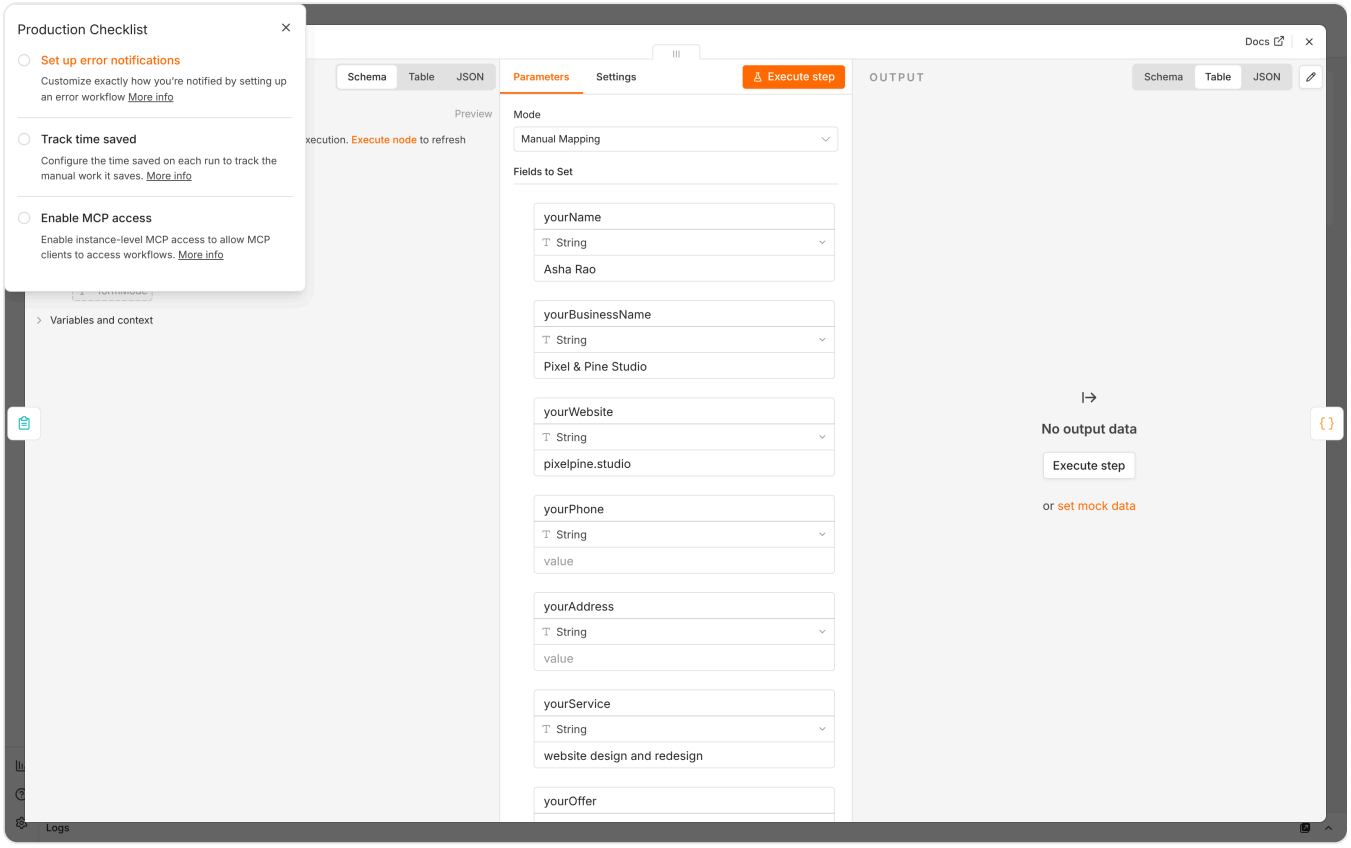
E. Connect n8n.

1. In the n8n credential dialog, paste the **Client ID** and **Client Secret**.
2. Click **Sign in with Google** and choose your account.
3. Google says "Google hasn't verified this app". That is fine for your own use. Click **Advanced** > **Go to Client Finder (unsafe)** and allow access.
4. Save, and select the credential on *Save to Google Sheet* too.
5. Create the Gmail credential on *Create Gmail Draft* the same way.

> **Tip:** Google only accepts redirect addresses with a domain name or `localhost`, not a bare IP address. Google Workspace users can choose **Internal** instead of **External**; then no test users or publishing are needed.

Step 6: Fill in the ⚙️ Settings node

1. Double-click ⚙️ *Settings*. Each field shows its name, its type and its value.
2. Click a value and type your own. For **createGmailDrafts**, choose `true` or `false`. Do not change the field names or types.
3. Close the node and click **Save**.



The ⚙️ Settings node. Change the values, never the names.

Field	Default	What to type
yourName	`Your Name`	**Required.** Your real name; it signs every email. The workflow will not run while it says "Your Name".
yourBusinessName	`Your Business`	Your business name (signature)
yourWebsite	empty	Optional, signature
yourPhone	empty	Optional, signature
yourAddress	empty	Your postal address (signature). **Fill it in if you email US businesses:** US law (CAN-SPAM) requires one in commercial email.
yourService	`website design and redesign`	What you sell. It should fit "I help businesses like yours with ...".

Field	Default	What to type
yourOffer	`a free 2-minute video showing exactly what I would fix`	One small, free next step that fits "Would it be useful if I sent you ...?". Only offer what you can deliver.
googleSheetUrl	`PASTE_YOUR_GOOGLE_SHEET_URL_HERE`	**Required.** The full sheet address from Step 3.
createGmailDrafts	`true`	`false` = pitches go only to the sheet
minScoreToPitch	`20`	Lower scores get no AI pitch. `30` = Warm and Hot only.
emailLanguage	`English`	For example `Spanish` or `Hindi`
emailTone	`friendly, direct and human`	A short tone instruction
maxEmailWords	`110`	Between 50 and 200
optOutLine	`P.S. If this isn't useful, just reply "no thanks" and I won't email again.`	Added to every first email. Keep it; translate it for other languages.
aiModel	`claude-opus-5-5`	Cheaper: `claude-sonnet-5-5` or `claude-haiku-4-5`
aiEffort	`low`	`low`, `medium` or `high`. Higher costs more. Some models ignore it.
searchLanguage	`en`	Language of Maps results (2-letter code)
searchCountryCode	empty	Optional country to favour: `US`, `GB` (not "UK"), `IN`, `AE`

Example: yourName `Asha Rao`, **yourBusinessName** `Pixel & Pine Studio`, **yourWebsite** `pixelpine.studio`, **yourService** `fast, mobile-friendly websites for local clinics`. These are made-up values.

Tip: The sign-off "Thanks," and the template pitch are always in English. Check them if you write in another language.

Step 7: Test, then switch it on

7.1 Run a test in the editor

1. Click **Save**, then **Execute workflow** at the bottom of the canvas (**Test workflow** in some versions). A test form opens in a new tab. If nothing opens, allow pop-ups.
2. Type `dentists` (or any business type) and your own city. Choose **20** businesses and click **Find clients**.
3. In the n8n tab, nodes turn green as they finish. A run takes about 2-6 minutes, then the test tab shows the results page.

4. Check the **Leads** tab of your sheet for new rows, and Gmail > **Drafts** for one draft per pitched business with a public email.

A test run costs the same as a normal run, and its leads stay in your sheet. If a node turns red, click it to read the error, then see Troubleshooting.

7.2 Activate or publish

- **n8n 1.x:** click the **Inactive** toggle at the top right so it shows **Active**.
- **n8n 2.x:** click **Publish** at the top right. After any later change, click **Publish** again.

7.3 Bookmark the form

1. Double-click *Find Clients Form*.
2. Switch from **Test URL** to **Production URL**.
3. Copy the address. It ends in `/form/client-finder-web-design`. Pro niches end in their own name, for example `/form/client-finder-seo`.
4. Open it in your browser and bookmark it.

> **Warning:** Anyone with the Production URL can run searches on your accounts. Keep it private.

Step 8: Read your results

The results page

After each run, the browser shows a short summary and an **Open your Google Sheet** link.

> **Example:** This is example data from our test businesses, not real results.
>
> **Done: 13 new leads found**
> Search: dentists in Austin, TX
> 13 new businesses saved to your sheet (1 hot, 6 warm).
> 7 personalized pitches written.
> 1 Gmail draft ready in Gmail > Drafts. Read each one before you send it.
> 5 pitched businesses have no public email: use the DM message or call opener in the sheet.
> Open your Google Sheet

Closed the tab by mistake? The run usually continues; check your sheet later.

Your sheet, column by column

Leads (example data) — dentists in Austin, TX

Business	Score	Priority	Problems	Email	Status
Bright Smile Studio	85	Hot	Not mobile-friendly, Not secure (no HTTPS), Outdated website, Weak SEO basics	smile@bright-smile.test	Pitch ready
Sunrise Family Dental, PLLC	50	Warm	Slow on mobile, Outdated website	info@sunrise-dental.test	Draft ready
Lakeside Dental Care	45	Warm	No website		Pitch ready
Oak Hill Orthodontics	45	Warm	Website down		Pitch ready
Maple Dental Group	45	Warm	Website down		Pitch ready
Pearl Dental Spa	40	Warm	Security certificate error		Pitch ready
Cedar Park Smiles	40	Warm	Placeholder website		Pitch ready
Elm Street Dental	10	Low	Weak SEO basics	contact@elm-dental.test	New
Downtown Dentistry	0	None		hello@downtown-dentistry.test	New

Example rows from our test data. Your leads will differ.

Column	What it shows
Place ID	Google's unique ID, used to skip businesses you already have. Never edit it.
Business	Name on Google Maps
Category	Main Google category, for example "Dentist"
Phone	Phone number listed on Google
Email	Email found on the homepage, if any
Website	Website listed on Google
Address	Full address
Google Maps	Link to the Maps listing
Rating	Google star rating (1-5)
Reviews	Number of Google reviews
Score	0-100
Priority	Hot, Warm, Low or None
Problems	Every problem found, biggest first
Top Problem	The biggest problem
Evidence	Numbered sentences that prove each problem
Email Subject	Subject line of the pitch
Email Body	The full email, with signature and opt-out line
DM Message	Short version for Instagram, WhatsApp or a contact form

Column	What it shows
Call Opener	One sentence to start a phone call
Status	Where the lead stands (see below)
Draft ID	Gmail's ID for the draft
Thread ID	Gmail's ID for the conversation, used by Pro follow-ups
Found On	Date the lead was found
Last Contacted	Date of your last email (you, or Pro's Autopilot, fill it in)
Follow-ups	Number of follow-ups sent (Pro)
Last Draft On	Date of the latest draft
Niche	The workflow that found it, for example "Web Design"
Search	For example "dentists in Austin, TX"
AI Status	Who wrote the pitch, or why there is none
Notes	Extras, such as other emails or a draft error

Statuses

Status	Meaning	Set by
New	No pitch: the score was too low or no problem was found	Workflow
Pitch ready	Pitch written, but no Gmail draft: no public email, drafts are off, or the draft failed (see **Notes**). Call, DM, or copy the email.	Workflow
Draft ready	A Gmail draft is waiting for you	Workflow
Contacted	You sent the first email	You (or Pro's Autopilot)
Follow-up drafted	A follow-up draft is waiting	Pro's Autopilot
Replied, **Meeting booked**, **Won**, **Lost**	Your progress with the lead	You (Pro's Autopilot sets **Replied**)
Do not contact	They asked you to stop. Never email them again.	You

Pick statuses from the dropdown. Never delete a row, even for a "no": the row stops future searches from adding that business again.

AI Status and Notes messages

Message	Meaning
Written by claude-opus-5-5	Claude wrote it (the model that answered is named)

Message	Meaning
... (after a retry)	The second try worked
Template used (AI error: ...)	Claude failed; the template pitch was used (see Troubleshooting)
Skipped (score below 20)	Score under **minScoreToPitch**, so no pitch
Skipped (no problems found)	Score 0, so no pitch
No website: call or DM instead.	(Notes) No website means no email to find
Other emails: ...	(Notes) More addresses found on the homepage
Gmail draft failed: ...	(Notes) The pitch is in the sheet, but Gmail refused the draft

Before you send a draft

Open Gmail > **Drafts** and check each email:

1. **Facts are right.** Compare it with the **Evidence** column, and open the website on your phone.
2. **Greeting fits**, for example "Hi Sunrise Family Dental team,".
3. **Offer is right**, and you can deliver it this week.
4. **Signature is complete**, with your address for US businesses. If Gmail adds your own signature too, remove one.
5. **Opt-out line is there.** Keep the "P.S." line.
6. **It sounds like you.** Change any word you would not say.

Then click **Send** and set the row's **Status** to **Contacted**.

> **Example:** The shape of a typical draft (made-up example; your drafts will differ):
>
> Hi Sunrise Family Dental team,
>
> Google's speed test scores your mobile site 23 out of 100, and the main content takes almost 10 seconds to appear on a phone. Many people give up before then and call the next dentist. Your footer also still says © 2019.
>
> I design fast, mobile-friendly websites. Would it be useful if I sent you a free 2-minute video showing exactly what I would fix?
>
> Thanks,
> Asha Rao
> Pixel & Pine Studio
>
> P.S. If this isn't useful, just reply "no thanks" and I won't email again.

Your daily routine

1. **Run one search a day** of 20 or 40 businesses.
2. **Rotate areas and business types**: nearby towns, then related types (`dentists` , `orthodontists` , `dental clinics`).

3. **Work Hot and Warm leads the same day.** Send their drafts; call or DM **Pitch ready** leads.
4. **Update the Status column** after every contact.
5. **Start with 10-20 emails a day** and grow slowly, so you are not marked as spam.

Re-running a search is safe: businesses already in your sheet are always skipped.

Troubleshooting

When the workflow stops early, the form shows a message with a title and a reason.

Messages from the workflow

Message	Cause	Fix
One setup step left (mentions "Your Name")	**yourName** still says "Your Name"	Type your real name in ⚙️ *Settings* and save (publish again on n8n 2.x).
One setup step left (mentions googleSheetUrl)	The sheet address is missing or incomplete	Paste the full address starting with `https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/`.
Missing search details	A form field was empty or only spaces	Fill in **Business type** and **City or area**.
Google Maps search failed: ...key was rejected	Wrong key or header name	In **Google API Key**, check **Name** is `X-Goog-Api-Key` and paste the key again.
Google Maps search failed: ...not enabled	Places API (New) is off	Enable it (Step 1.3), wait 2 minutes, retry.
Google Maps search failed: ...billing account	No billing	Link a billing account (Step 1.2).
Google Maps search failed: ...application restriction	The key blocks servers	**Application restrictions**: **None** (Step 1.4).
Google Maps search failed: ...quota or rate limit	Too many requests	Wait a few minutes, or raise the quota.
Google Maps search failed: ...permission denied	Key or API problem	Check the key and that both APIs are enabled and ticked.
No businesses found	No open businesses matched	Try a bigger area, check the spelling, or a more common type.
Couldn't open your Google Sheet	Wrong address, no **Leads** tab, still an .xlsx file, or the Sheets credential uses another account	Fix the address, use the converted sheet (Step 3), or reconnect with the sheet owner's account.
Nothing new this time	Every business found is already in your sheet	Try a nearby area or a related business type.
Gmail draft failed: ... (Notes)	Gmail credential missing or expired	Reconnect it. The pitch is in the sheet; copy it into an email.

Message	Cause	Fix
Template used (AI error: ...) (AI Status)	Claude failed twice, or the error was permanent	See the next table. Review template pitches closely.

> **Tip:** Some messages say "step 2 of the setup guide". In this guide, that is Step 1 (Google Cloud).

Other common problems

Problem	Fix
n8n says the workflow has issues, or a node shows a red warning	A credential is not selected. Open that node and choose it (Step 5).
AI Status mentions 401 or "invalid x-api-key"	In **Anthropic API Key**, **Name** must be `x-api-key` and **Value** your full `sk-ant-` key, on both Claude nodes.
AI Status mentions credit or billing	Buy credits in the Anthropic Console.
AI Status mentions the model	**aiModel** is misspelled or not available on your account. Use `claude-opus-5-5`.
AI Status mentions "Rate limited"	In *Write Pitch with Claude*, lower **Options** > **Batching** > **Items per Batch** (for example to `2`), or search 20 at a time.
Google says 403	An API is not enabled, or the key is restricted to the wrong APIs or from another project. Recheck Step 1.
No lead ever shows "Slow on mobile" or "Not secure (no HTTPS)"	PageSpeed is probably failing. Check **PageSpeed Insights API** is enabled and ticked on your key. In **Executions**, open a run and click *PageSpeed Test* to see its output.
The form address shows 404 or "not found"	The workflow is not active or published (Step 7.2), or it is the Test URL, or the file was imported twice.
Self-hosted: the Production URL shows `localhost`	Set n8n's `WEBHOOK_URL` setting to your public n8n address.
A run takes a long time	Each PageSpeed test can take up to a minute, 5 at a time, so 60 businesses can take over 6 minutes. If n8n stops long runs, search 20 or 40 at a time.
Self-hosted: Google stops working after about a week	The consent screen is still in **Testing**. Publish it (Step 5.4 D) and sign in again in both credentials.
Google shows "redirect_uri_mismatch"	The redirect address in Google Cloud must match the n8n **OAuth Redirect URL** exactly.
Save to Google Sheet turns red	Check the **Leads** header row is unchanged. Delete that run's Gmail drafts before searching again: those businesses were not saved.

Still stuck? Email support@example.com with your n8n version (Cloud or self-hosted), the node and the exact message. Never send your API keys.

FAQ

Why at most 60 businesses per search?

Google returns at most 60 results per search. For more, search nearby areas or related business types.

Can I use it in other countries and languages?

Yes. Set **searchCountryCode** (for example `IN`, `GB`, `US`) and **searchLanguage** (for example `en`, `es`, `hi`) for the Maps results. Set **emailLanguage** for the pitches, and translate **optOutLine**.

How do I change the AI model?

Type another model name in **aiModel**, for example `claude-sonnet-5-5` or `claude-haiku-4-5`. They cost less; compare a few drafts.

Why drafts instead of sending?

You stay in control: you check every fact and send from your own inbox. That protects your reputation and your email account.

Can I edit the checks?

Pro buyers: see PRO-GUIDE.pdf. Starter buyers: double-click *Prepare Search* and scroll down to the block that starts with `const NICHE_PACK`. In its `weights` list, change a number to give a check more or fewer points, or set it to `0` to turn it off. Edit with care, keep the original file as a backup, then save (and publish again on n8n 2.x). Want more niches? See https://YOUR-STORE.gumroad.com/l/client-finder

Is it legal?

The workflow uses Google's official Places API, reads only public homepages and never sends anything: you choose who to email. You are responsible for following Google's terms and the email rules where you and your recipients are. In the US, CAN-SPAM requires an honest subject, your postal address and an opt-out. The UK, the EU, India and other places have their own rules. This guide is not legal advice.

Which n8n versions does it work on?

n8n 1.123 or newer, including 2.x, on Cloud or self-hosted. It was tested end to end on n8n 1.123.83 and 2.42.3.

This guide is for Client Finder Agent version 1.0.0.